Equity Method Investment Earnings

We include our share of the earnings of certain affiliates based on our economic ownership interest in the affiliates. Significant affiliates include the Ardent Mills joint venture and affiliates that produce and market potato products for retail and foodservice customers. Our share of earnings from our equity method investments was $122.1 million ($119.1 million in the Commercial Foods segment and $3.0 million in the Consumer Foods segment) and $32.5 million ($29.7 million in the Commercial Foods segment and $2.8 million in the Consumer Foods segment) in fiscal 2015 and 2014, respectively. The increase in fiscal 2015 compared to fiscal 2014 reflects the earnings from the Ardent Mills joint venture as well as higher profits for an international potato joint venture. The earnings from the Ardent Mills joint venture reflect results for 11 months of operations, as we recognize earnings on a one-month lag, due to differences in fiscal year periods. In fiscal 2014, earnings also reflected a $3.4 million charge reflecting the year-end write-off of actuarial losses in excess of 10% of the pension liability for an international potato venture.

Results of Discontinued Operations

Our discontinued operations generated after-tax income of $366.6 million and $141.4 million in fiscal 2015 and 2014, respectively. The results of discontinued operations for fiscal 2015 include a pre-tax gain of $625.6 million ($379.6 million after-tax) recognized on the formation of the Ardent Mills joint venture. The results for fiscal 2014 reflect a pre-tax gain of $90.0 million ($55.7 million after-tax) related to the disposition of three flour milling facilities as part of the Ardent Mills formation.

In fiscal 2014, we also completed the sale of a small snack business, Medallion Foods, for $32.0 million in cash. We recognized an after-tax loss of $3.5 million on the sale of this business in fiscal 2014. In fiscal 2014, we recognized an impairment charge related to allocated amounts of goodwill and intangible assets, totaling $15.2 million after-tax, in anticipation of this divestiture. We also completed the sale of the assets of the *Lightlife*® business for $54.7 million in cash. We recognized an after-tax gain of $19.8 million on the sale of this business in fiscal 2014.

Earnings (Loss) Per Share

Diluted loss per share in fiscal 2015 was $0.60, including a loss of $1.46 per diluted share from continuing operations and earnings of $0.86 per diluted share from discontinued operations. Diluted earnings per share in fiscal 2014 were $0.70, including $0.37 per diluted share from continuing operations and $0.33 per diluted share from discontinued operations. See *"Items Impacting Comparability"* above as several significant items affected the comparability of year-over-year results of operations.

Fiscal 2014 compared to Fiscal 2013

Net Sales

($ in millions) **Reporting Segment**	**Fiscal 2014 Net Sales**	**Fiscal 2013 Net Sales**	**% Inc (Dec)**
Consumer Foods	7,315.7	7,551.4	(3)%
Commercial Foods	4,332.2	4,109.7	5 %
Private Brands	4,195.7	1,808.2	132 %
Total	$ 15,843.6	$ 13,469.3	18 %

Overall, our net sales increased $2.37 billion to $15.84 billion in fiscal 2014 compared to fiscal 2013, primarily related to the acquisition of Ralcorp.

Consumer Foods net sales for fiscal 2014 were $7.32 billion, a decrease of $235.7 million, or 3%, compared to fiscal 2013. Results reflected a 3% decrease in volume performance and a 1% decrease due to the impact of foreign exchange rates, partially offset by a 1% increase in price/mix. Volume performance from our base businesses for fiscal 2014 was impacted negatively by competitor promotional activity. Significant slotting and promotion investments related to new product launches, particularly in the first quarter, also weighed heavily on net sales in fiscal 2014. In addition, certain shipments planned for the fourth quarter of fiscal 2014 were shifted to the first quarter of fiscal 2015 as a result of change in timing of retailer promotions and this negatively impacted volume performance.